

5.3 COMPONENT 3 - LISTENING PAPER

This component will assess candidates' abilities to use their listening skills to demonstrate their knowledge, aural perception and understanding of the musical elements, devices, tonalities, structures, conventions, processes, notations and the impact and uses of ICT.

The recorded extracts will be taken exclusively from repertoire defined in Areas of Study 2, 3 and 4.

The musical features which candidates should know and be able to recognise aurally are defined generally and in relation to each Area of Study in the Language for Learning sections (summarised in Appendix A). Candidates need to learn not only to identify such straightforward sounds as those of instruments and intervals but also relevant techniques and compositional processes. They should understand and be able to use the technical terms listed in Language for Learning: these may be used in the framing of questions, as well as being required in both one-word and longer answers.

The use of non-technical language to communicate aural perception and responses is in itself a skill which candidates should be given opportunities to practise and develop as they encounter new music in each Area of Study. They are expected to be able to:

- describe e.g. musical features, textures
- compare (identify similarities and differences between examples of a genre)
- explain e.g. how 'effects' were created
- comment (drawing attention to what is significant)
- make and support evaluative judgements (informed by understanding of the typical processes and contexts in the relevant Area of Study)

Candidates are also expected to be able to use graphic notation and simple staff notation.